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FREE WORKBOOK · 2026 EDITION

Email and WhatsApp Marketing Starter Kit

The real secret to growing any business is turning a first-time buyer into a customer who comes back again and again. The best way to do that? Keep talking to them, by email and on...



5 pages · PDF

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The real secret to growing any business is turning a first-time buyer into a customer who comes back again and again. The best way to do that? Keep talking to them, by email and on WhatsApp. It may sound hard, but it is simply friendly messages that go out at the right time, many of them automatically.

This starter kit is your simple, three-step plan. It gives you the tools and message templates you need to build loyal customers from day one.

01 Step 1: Gather Your Essential Tools

Before you write a single message, you need two things: a tool to send from and a way to collect contacts.

- Choose a Beginner-Friendly Email Tool: Do not send business emails one by one from your personal Gmail. Use a tool made for the job. Mailchimp, Brevo and MailerLite are good for beginners. They have free plans, connect to your online store, and come with ready-made templates and automation (messages that send by themselves).
- Set Up WhatsApp Business: Many Nigerian customers read WhatsApp before email. Use broadcast lists to send updates to people who saved your number and agreed to hear from you. Peggy, the Shopinbos AI assistant, can help you reply to the chats that come back.
- Set Up a Simple Sign-Up Form: Your first goal is to build a list of contacts. Put a pop-up or a form on your store asking for an email address and WhatsApp number. Offer a small reward, like 10% off the first order or free delivery within Lagos, in exchange. This is the base for all your future sales.

02 Step 2: Set Up Your "Set It and Forget It" Messages

This is where it gets exciting. Automated sequences are messages you write once, and they send by themselves based on what a customer does. Set them up once and they work for you day and night.

- The Welcome Series: As soon as someone signs up, this series starts.
  - Message 1 (immediately): "Thank you for joining!" and their discount code.
  - Message 2 (2 days later): Share your story. Why did you start this business? For example, "I started Adaeze's Naturals because I couldn't find pure shea butter in Enugu."
  - Message 3 (4 days later): Show your three most popular products with prices in naira.
- The Abandoned Cart Flow: An "abandoned cart" is when someone adds items to their cart but leaves without paying. This flow helps you win back those sales.
  - Message 1 (1 hour after they leave): "Did you forget something?" Gently remind them of what they left, with a clear picture of the product.

- Message 2 (24 hours later): “Still thinking about it?” Add a bit of urgency or proof from other buyers, like “Only 5 left in stock” or a short customer review. Remind them they can pay by transfer, card or on delivery.
- Message 3 (3 days later): “Last chance!” Offer a final discount that ends soon to encourage them to complete the order.

03 Step 3: Create Your Core Message Templates

Apart from automated messages, you need a few ready templates for one-off campaigns. Having them ready saves you hours of thinking about what to write.

1. The “New Product” Template: Announce a new item with excitement. Focus on what the customer gets from it, use clear photos and add a big “Shop Now” button or store link. Example: “New in: hand-dyed adire two-piece sets. Sizes 8–18. Order now and get delivery in Lagos in 2 days.”
2. The “Helpful Tips” Newsletter Template: Do not only sell; give value. Share tips related to your products. For example, if you sell hair, send “5 ways to make your wig last longer.” This builds trust and keeps your brand in your customers’ minds.
3. The “Seasonal Sale” Template: For Detty December, Valentine’s, Eid, Easter, back-to-school or Black Friday. Make it simple and bold: say what is on sale, the discount and the end date. Example: “Detty December Sale: 20% off all perfume oils until 24 December. Order by 20 December for delivery before Christmas.”

04 Your Action Plan: Start This Week

1. Day 1: Sign up for a free email tool and set up WhatsApp Business.
2. Day 2: Add a sign-up form with a discount to your store.
3. Day 3: Write and set up your 3-part Welcome Series.
4. Day 4: Build your Abandoned Cart flow.
5. Day 5: Draft your “New Product” template for later.

Remember, the goal is progress, not perfection. Your messages do not need to be beautiful essays. They need to be helpful and human. By focusing on these three areas, you are not just sending messages. You are building a system that brings customers back and grows your business steadily.

Ready to use these templates but need a store first? At Shopinbos, Rex builds your store, and payments, deliveries and chats with Peggy all run in one place. Explore our resources and launch with confidence.

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Ready to make your first sale?

Rex builds your store with you in 5 minutes. Take card, transfer and pay on delivery, book riders, and let Peggy answer customers on WhatsApp.

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